

» Ajay Seth, Secretary, Department of Economic Affairs, was asked about the rationale behind the removal of indexation benefits for long-term capital gains on real estate, particularly given that revenue generation was not the stated objective. Seth said historically, the Indian taxation policy was instrumental in steering investments towards specific asset classes

» Asked about the government's thinking

behind, and the potential impact, of the changes in the income tax regime in consumer spending, Agarwal said the new tax regime offers several benefits to taxpayers and by simplifying the tax slabs and eliminating many deductions, individuals have more disposable income

» Speaking on the goods and services tax, CBIC Chairman Sanjay Kumar Agarwal highlighted the robust revenue growth from GST and said the committee has been already constituted to examine GST rate rationalisation



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UNLEASHING THE ANIMAL SPIRITS

● (From left) **Vinod Aggarwal**, MD & CEO, VE Commercial Vehicles and President, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers

● **Dhruv Agarwala**, Group CEO, Housing.com & PropTiger.com

● **Vineet Agarwal**, MD, Transport Corporation of India

» Vinod Aggarwal highlighted the lack of private investments in recent times in comparison to public capex. He said the auto industry is doing well even though the sale of entry-level passenger cars and two-wheelers has been under stress for several quarters

» Speaking on the positives for the real estate sector in the

Budget, Dhruv Agarwala said the allocation to Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban) will provide it a fillip

» Vineet Agarwal said he believes that the Budget is now becoming one of the directional documents for growth in India and that the animal spirits will only come when there is confidence in the system